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Financing of the United Nations Mission for the Referendum in Western Sahara

Budget performance for the period from 1 July 2024 to 30 June 2025 and budget for the period from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027 for the United Nations Mission for the Referendum in Western Sahara

Report of the Secretary-General

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Summary

The present report contains the budget performance of and the budget for the United Nations Mission for the Referendum in Western Sahara (MINURSO) for the period from 1 July 2024 to 30 June 2025 and from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027, respectively.

During the 2024/25 period, the Mission continued to implement the tasks mandated by the Security Council in its resolutions [2703 \(2023\)](#) and [2756 \(2024\)](#), which included monitoring, investigating and reporting on the parties' activities through ground and air patrols conducted by military observers to promote a cessation of hostilities, and to contribute to achieving a just, lasting and mutually acceptable political solution to the question of Western Sahara by providing an environment conducive to the efforts of the Personal Envoy of the Secretary-General for Western Sahara. Through its Mine Action Service, the Mission continued its mine action operations within the constraints of renewed hostilities between the parties.

During the 2026/27 period, MINURSO will continue to implement its mandate. The Mission will continue to investigate alleged incidents related to aerial strikes and firing incidents, leveraging its role as a conflict prevention mechanism to reduce the risk of potential escalation and as the main and often sole source of impartial information in the Territory.

Financial resources

During the 2024/25 period, MINURSO incurred \$64.7 million in expenditure, representing a resource utilization rate of 94.1 per cent, compared with \$64.2 million in expenditure and a resource utilization rate of 99.5 per cent in the 2023/24 period.

The unencumbered balance of \$4.1 million reflects the net impact of: (a) the increased requirements under military and police personnel, attributable primarily to the higher mission subsistence allowance rates, effective 1 January 2025; offset in part by (b) the reduced requirements for civilian personnel, attributable primarily to the application of vacancy rates higher than those approved; and (c) the reduced requirements for operational costs attributable to the lower actual costs and volume of petrol, oil and lubricants and the reprioritization of resources in light of liquidity challenges.

The budget proposed for the 2026/27 period in the amount of \$62.7 million represents a decrease of \$8.0 million, or 11.3 per cent, compared with the apportionment of \$70.7 million approved for the 2025/26 period.

The estimates for the 2026/27 period reflect reduced requirements for: (a) military and police personnel, owing primarily to the non-deployment of the medical military contingent and higher vacancy rates for military observers; (b) civilian personnel, due to the abolishment of 23 posts and the application of vacancy rates higher than those approved; and (c) operational costs, due mainly to the reconfiguration of the fixed-wing fleet through the reduction of one aircraft to enhance operational efficiency, a lower number of vehicle replacements compared with the 2025/26 approved budget, and reduced fuel consumption and costs due to solar panel installations, decreased patrols east of the berm and fewer flight hours than previously budgeted.

(Thousands of United States dollars; budget year is from 1 July to 30 June)

Category	2024/25 apportionment	2024/25 expenditure	Variance		2025/26 apportionment	2026/27 cost estimates	Variance	
			Unencumbered balance	Percentage			Amount	Percentage
Military and police personnel	7 425.1	8 320.5	(895.4)	(12.1)	8 879.5	7 064.6	(1 814.9)	(20.4)
Civilian personnel	25 334.7	25 157.5	177.2	0.7	26 196.6	23 620.3	(2 576.3)	(9.8)
Operational costs	36 031.3	31 254.4	4 776.9	13.3	35 618.0	32 024.4	(3 593.6)	(10.1)
Gross requirements	68 791.1	64 732.4	4 058.7	5.9	70 694.1	62 709.3	(7 984.8)	(11.3)
Staff assessment income	2 849.0	2 978.3	(129.3)	(4.5)	3 095.2	2 865.2	(230.0)	(7.4)
Net requirements	65 942.1	61 754.1	4 188.0	6.4	67 598.9	59 844.1	(7 754.8)	(11.5)
Voluntary contributions in kind (budgeted)	519.0	217.0	302.0	58.2	519.0	519.0	—	—
Total requirements	69 310.1	64 949.4	4 360.7	6.3	71 213.1	63 228.3	(7 984.8)	(11.2)

Human resources^a

The proposed budget provides for the deployment of uniformed personnel and civilian staff as follows:

	Military observers	Military contingents	United Nations police	Formed police units	Inter- national staff	National Professional Officers	National General Service	Temporary positions ^b	United Nations Volunteers ^c	Government- provided personnel	Total
Executive direction and management											
Approved 2024/25	—	—	—	—	14	—	9	1	—	—	24
Actual 2024/25	—	—	—	—	12	—	8	1	—	—	21
Approved 2025/26	—	—	—	—	14	—	9	1	—	—	24
Proposed 2026/27	—	—	—	—	11	1	9	1	—	—	22
Components											
Substantive civilian											
Approved 2024/25	—	—	12	—	4	—	—	—	—	10	26
Actual 2024/25	—	—	2	—	3	—	—	—	—	—	5
Approved 2025/26	—	—	12	—	4	—	—	—	—	10	26
Proposed 2026/27	—	—	12	—	3	—	—	—	—	10	25
Military											
Approved 2024/25	218	27	—	—	2	—	—	—	—	—	247
Actual 2024/25	189	26	—	—	2	—	—	—	—	—	217
Approved 2025/26	218	27	—	—	2	—	—	—	—	—	247
Proposed 2026/27	218	27	—	—	2	—	—	—	—	—	247
Support											
Approved 2024/25	—	—	—	—	67	2	152	—	17	—	238
Actual 2024/25	—	—	—	—	61	2	140	—	14	—	217
Approved 2025/26	—	—	—	—	67	2	152	—	17	—	238
Proposed 2026/27	—	—	—	—	64	2	135	—	17	—	218

	<i>Military observers</i>	<i>Military contingents</i>	<i>United Nations police</i>	<i>Formed police units</i>	<i>Inter- national staff</i>	<i>National Professional Officers</i>	<i>National General Service</i>	<i>Temporary positions^b</i>	<i>United Nations Volunteers^c</i>	<i>Government- provided personnel</i>	<i>Total</i>
Total											
Approved 2024/25	218	27	12	–	87	2	161	1	17	10	535
Actual 2024/25	189	26	2	–	78	2	148	1	14	–	460
Approved 2025/26	218	27	12	–	87	2	161	1	17	10	535
Proposed 2026/27	218	27	12	–	80	3	144	1	17	10	512
Net change	–	–	–	–	(7)	1	(17)	–	–	–	(23)

^a Represents the highest level of authorized/proposed strength.

^b Funded under general temporary assistance.

^c Includes international and national United Nations Volunteers.

Legislative history

(Thousands of United States dollars)

	2024/25			2025/26		
	<i>Report</i>	<i>Date</i>	<i>Amount</i>	<i>Report</i>	<i>Date</i>	<i>Amount</i>
Proposed budget – Secretary-General	A/78/723	22 January 2024	70 711.0	A/79/736	20 January 2025	71 808.4
Recommendation – Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions	A/78/744/Add.12	5 April 2024	70 291.1	A/79/724/Add.8	14 April 2025	71 259.6
Appropriation ^a – General Assembly	A/RES/78/307	28 June 2024	68 791.1	A/RES/79/310	30 June 2025	70 694.1
Appropriation (net)			65 942.1			67 598.9

^a The total amount has been assessed on Member States.

The actions to be taken by the General Assembly are set out in section IV of the present report.

I. Mandate, results achieved and planned outcome

A. Mandate

1. The mandate of the United Nations Mission for the Referendum in Western Sahara (MINURSO) was established by the Security Council in its resolution [690 \(1991\)](#). The mandate for the performance period was provided in its resolutions [2703 \(2023\)](#) and [2756 \(2024\)](#). The most recent extension of the mandate was authorized by the Council in its resolution [2797 \(2025\)](#), by which it extended the mandate until 31 October 2026.
2. The Mission is mandated to help the Security Council to achieve an overall objective, namely, a just, lasting and mutually acceptable political solution, which will provide for the self-determination of the people of Western Sahara.

B. Budget implementation for 2024/25

3. During the 2024/25 period, MINURSO observed, monitored, investigated and reported on the low-intensity conflict between Morocco and Frente Popular para la Liberación de Saguía el-Hamra y de Río de Oro (Frente POLISARIO), as well as general developments affecting Western Sahara, and regularly liaised with the civilian and military leadership of the parties to achieve a cessation of hostilities and reduced tensions.
4. MINURSO conducted regular ground patrols and, west of the berm, aerial reconnaissance using helicopters. These monitoring efforts helped to maintain stability and avoid escalation, while firing incidents at or near the berm continued to decline. In total, 153 firing incidents were reported by the Royal Moroccan Army against its units at or near the berm (235 in the 2023/24 period). In coordination with the Royal Moroccan Army and Frente POLISARIO, MINURSO investigated 11 alleged strikes conducted by Royal Moroccan Army uncrewed aerial vehicles east of the berm out of 20 reported by open sources. With support from mine action experts, MINURSO military observers independently confirmed that aerial strikes had occurred in several cases. They assessed that these strikes had resulted in 3 casualties, 2 killed and 1 injured, marking a notable reduction from the 17 killed and 7 injured in the previous period. MINURSO also responded swiftly to four reported rocket attacks in the city of Smara, one occurring within 200 m of a MINURSO team site. Although no casualties were reported, the Mission's investigation confirmed that the rockets had been launched from areas located east of the berm. Through its continued presence, impartial monitoring, and investigations, MINURSO played a stabilizing role and contributed situational awareness and risk reduction across its area of operations.
5. The Mission's sustained engagement with Frente POLISARIO, particularly through regular interactions between the mission leadership and the Frente POLISARIO Coordinator, improved stability at team sites east of the berm. As a result, ground convoys now occur roughly every month, under provisional movement approvals from Frente POLISARIO. The Mission also maintained close coordination with both parties to ensure the necessary security assurances for its operations. While a long-term, formal agreement with Frente POLISARIO remained pending, MINURSO efforts have helped to preserve access and to support limited operational continuity in these areas. Despite this progress, operational restrictions remained. Ground patrols east of the berm were still limited to a 20-km radius from the team sites, and no helicopter reconnaissance flights were allowed to resume. Nonetheless, the Mission's diplomatic engagement and persistent coordination remained critical to maintaining a functional presence and mitigating risks.

6. Mine action remained critical to safe mandate implementation. Throughout the 2024/25 period, the Mine Action Service of the United Nations provided essential support to the Mission, including emergency disposal of explosive ordnance, route verification, and combined explosive ordnance risk education. Mine action personnel also supported investigation patrols at alleged uncrewed aerial vehicle strike sites and ensured safe passage for ground convoys operating east of the berm. Notably, for the sixteenth consecutive year, there were no explosive hazard-related incidents during the conduct of MINURSO operational activities, demonstrating continued effectiveness of the Mission's mine action programme.

7. During 2024/25, MINURSO maintained a high level of operational effectiveness through logistical support, infrastructure enhancements and strategic use of aviation assets. These efforts supported patrols, ensured the safety of personnel and sustained its presence in remote locations.

8. The Mission operated two fixed-wing and three rotary-wing aircraft, enabling air patrols, casualty evacuation operations and logistical support. Following a strategic optimization in October 2024, the rotary-wing fleet was reduced by one aircraft. By shifting to integrated passenger and cargo operations, the Mission improved the utilization and operational efficiency of the remaining air assets, maintaining capacity with fewer resources.

9. Ground transportation support remained uninterrupted, with the Mission's fleet maintained effectively to meet operational demands. In the east of the berm, where terrain and access constraints remain significant, MINURSO sustained supply lines to team sites through targeted interventions. Diesel fuel and food rations were airlifted to establish a three-month contingency buffer, ensuring uninterrupted operations.

10. The Mission continued to strengthen infrastructure, accommodation, and service facilities across all locations, with energy-efficient air-conditioning units and LED lighting installed at all mission locations. To enhance the sustainable power supply, self-standing solar street lights were deployed and solar-diesel hybrid power systems totalling 700 kw were operated at six team sites, delivering significant fuel savings, while infrastructure for a seventh 100 kW system at team site Agwanit east of the berm was completed.

11. Technological enhancements contributed to improved situational awareness, communication and operational safety. A satellite-based live tracking system was deployed for patrols and convoys, with data integrated into the Military Operations Centre via the Situational Awareness Geospatial Enterprise platform. Upgraded video walls (central monitoring screens) provided real-time monitoring capabilities to support rapid incident response. Satellite-based push-to-talk systems continued replacing legacy high-frequency radios, while geospatial imagery and mapping tools supported threat analysis, route planning and patrol coordination. To support operational planning and continuity, the Mission strengthened its remote asset management capabilities and installed the necessary infrastructure for the Unite field remote infrastructure monitoring system at all team sites west of the berm.

12. While the Mission delivered its mandate effectively, resource constraints remained a key challenge. Financial limitations required the Mission to operate with a reduced fleet and ageing equipment, much of which has exceeded its expected life cycle.

C. Planning assumptions and mission support initiatives for 2026/27

13. The Mission's primary strategic objectives are to observe, monitor, investigate and report on key developments in the Territory and maintain a sustainable presence throughout the Territory. Through active engagement with the parties, the Mission

will continue advocating a cessation of hostilities and a return to a full ceasefire, reinforcing its role as a conflict prevention mechanism and helping to create an environment conducive to the political process.

14. MINURSO will continue ground and aerial patrols by United Nations military observers across its 266,000 km² area of operations. These activities rely on full freedom of movement on both sides of the berm enabling unrestricted patrols and helicopter reconnaissance. MINURSO will review its patrol strategy to maximize its presence and investigations in at-risk areas. It will adjust patrolling routes and schedules to reflect the security situation as required. The Mission will investigate alleged incidents related to hostilities, leveraging its role as a conflict prevention mechanism and as the only impartial international observer in the Territory.

15. While the sustainability of the team sites east of the berm has stabilized, MINURSO will continue to insist on full freedom of movement and seek an agreement with Frente POLISARIO on a sustainable solution for logistical and resupply ground convoys east of the berm.

16. The military component will continue to monitor and investigate military activities on the ground, engaging both parties to reduce tensions and support a full ceasefire. The main priorities for the 2026/27 period remain air and land patrols and analysis of data obtained from ground sources, aviation reconnaissance and satellite imagery, along with engagement with the parties.

17. MINURSO will strengthen its data-driven decision-making through improved situational awareness and planning tools, such as the Comprehensive Planning and Performance Assessment System and the Situational Awareness Geospatial Enterprise databases.

18. MINURSO will implement its mine action programme and release land free of explosive hazards to ensure that its operational activities are conducted in full security and safety. It will continue explosive ordnance risk education for mission personnel and the local population. This improves access for military observers and supports the safe return of land to local communities. The Mission will maintain a dedicated capacity for explosive ordnance disposal and clearance and investigative support for timely responses to emerging threats.

19. MINURSO will continue to address disinformation and misinformation regarding ongoing hostilities and the role of the Mission in promoting stability in the region, in addition to galvanizing support for military observers.

Mission support initiatives

20. During 2026/27, the MINURSO support component will continue to provide efficient and effective administrative and logistical support through continued service enhancements across all locations.

21. The Mission operates in a challenging desert environment characterized by extreme temperatures and frequent sandstorms, which places significant demands on personnel, equipment, and maintenance resources. These conditions are compounded by the long distances between headquarters, liaison offices and remote team sites, affecting both air and ground mobility. To address these constraints, the Mission adopted strategies to optimize resource allocation, maintaining adequate reserves and ensuring that team sites remain self-sustaining for extended periods. These measures, supported by comprehensive security assessments, support operational continuity and safeguard the welfare of personnel.

22. The Mission will continue upgrading and maintaining infrastructure, accommodation, service facilities and its environmental action plan across all locations.

Prefabricated ablution units will be replaced with permanent hard-walled facilities to improve hygiene and support long-term operational needs.

23. The Mission will operate with one fixed-wing and two rotary-wing aircraft to meet operational requirements within the area of responsibility. Air assets remain critical in sustaining logistical resupply, conducting aerial patrols and providing timely casualty and medical evacuation capabilities, ensuring efficient air operations.

24. The Mission will maintain operational oversight of its 350 vehicles and continue the phased replacement of ageing assets, with particular attention to convoy trucks operating in demanding conditions, to ensure uninterrupted resupply capabilities. The Mission will continue to use handheld Global Positioning System (GPS) devices for geolocation of convoy and patrol movements for security purposes. Satellite tracking subscriptions have been activated for a limited number of devices, covering less than 10 per cent of the fleet, with a planned gradual increase throughout 2026/27.

25. The Mission will continue to provide information technology, communications and geospatial information services across 13 locations, ensuring resilient connectivity despite the challenging operational environment. Priority will be given to the phased replacement of ageing information and communications technology equipment, particularly outdated edge security systems. Geographic information system capabilities will be strengthened through enhanced mapping and geospatial analysis of convoy routes. The deployment of low Earth orbit satellite-based Internet will expand access to corporate cloud platforms for remote team sites, supporting uninterrupted digital services for mission activities.

26. The Mission will install a solar-diesel hybrid power system at team site Agwanit, procure an additional solar system for team site Tifariti and deploy stand-alone solar street lights to improve efficiency and safety. Further measures include landscaping, tree planting, the use of treated wastewater for irrigation and the deployment of the Unite field remote infrastructure monitoring system for collecting and analysing infrastructure and environmental data.

27. In the context of the Secretary-General's UN80 Initiative, the proposed budget reflects targeted efficiency measures through organizational optimization, functional streamlining and more efficient resource allocation. These measures follow a comprehensive review of operational requirements, workload distribution and support functions. With improved local medical infrastructure, the medical support previously provided by the troop-contributing countries will now be provided by a commercial medical provider, complemented by the Mission's internal capabilities. This ensures continued access to high-quality medical care for personnel east of the berm while optimizing costs. In parallel, the Mission implemented targeted reductions in United Nations police and military staff officer positions, in line with evolving priorities. These adjustments enable MINURSO to maintain mandate-critical functions and ensure the efficient allocation of resources.

28. The Mission proposes the abolishment of 6 international and 17 national General Service staff posts. Civilian staffing reductions result from functional streamlining and organizational optimization, including the redistribution of responsibilities, the consolidation of functions and adjustments to internal workflows. In some cases, functions from abolished posts will be absorbed by remaining positions, allowing the Mission to operate more efficiently while maintaining essential capacities.

29. The proposed efficiency measures create a more streamlined organizational structure with a stronger focus on mandate-related activities. The transition from medical support traditionally provided by troop-contributing countries to civilian medical services, complemented by the Mission's internal medical capacity and expanded support from the host authority, ensures that essential health services

remain uninterrupted. Overall, these adjustments balance operational effectiveness with reduced staffing levels, enabling MINURSO to sustain mandate delivery within the available resources.

30. To mitigate potential risks associated with these efficiency measures, the Mission has strengthened internal coordination, management oversight and prioritization mechanisms. Resources remain focused on critical mandate-related tasks, and coordination between civilian and uniformed components is reinforced to ensure continuity of operations. The Mission will continue to monitor the impact of the efficiency measures, including changes in equipment allocation, and take corrective action, as necessary, to ensure effective mandate delivery.

D. Regional mission cooperation

31. During the 2024/25 period, MINURSO worked closely with the Regional Service Centre in Entebbe, Uganda (RSCE), on human resources and financial transactions in accordance with the signed service-level agreement. In coordination with the United Nations Logistics Base at Brindisi, Italy (UNLB), MINURSO continued working on the deployment of the United field remote infrastructure monitoring system for improved oversight of mission assets and infrastructure.

32. During the 2026/27 period, MINURSO will continue regional cooperation with RSCE and UNLB and will seek support from other missions in the region, United Nations Headquarters and UNLB for training and logistics as required.

E. Human resources¹

Executive direction and management

	International staff						National staff			UNV			
	USG- ASG	D-2- D-1	P-5- P-4	P-3- P-2	FS	Subtotal	NPO	NGS	Subtotal	Inter- national	National	Subtotal	Total
<i>Civilian staff</i>													
Approved posts 2024/25	1	2	5	3	3	14	–	9	9	–	–	–	23
Actual posts 2024/25	1	2	4	2	3	12	–	8	8	–	–	–	20
Approved posts 2025/26	1	2	5	3	3	14	–	9	9	–	–	–	23
Proposed posts 2026/27	1	2	4	1	3	11	1	9	10	–	–	–	21
Net change	–	–	(1)	(2)	–	(3)	1	–	1	–	–	–	(2)
Approved temporary positions ^a 2024/25	–	–	1	–	–	1	–	–	–	–	–	–	1
Actual temporary positions ^a 2024/25	–	–	1	–	–	1	–	–	–	–	–	–	1
Approved temporary positions ^a 2025/26	–	–	1	–	–	1	–	–	–	–	–	–	1
Proposed temporary positions ^a 2026/27	–	–	1	–	–	1	–	–	–	–	–	–	1
Net change	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–
Total, including temporary positions													
Approved 2024/25	1	2	6	3	3	15	–	9	9	–	–	–	24
Actual 2024/25	1	2	5	2	3	13	–	8	8	–	–	–	21

Note: The following abbreviations are used in the tables: ASG, Assistant Secretary-General; FS, Field Service; NGS, national General Service; NPO, National Professional Officer; UNV, United Nations Volunteers; USG, Under-Secretary-General.

¹ The actual number of posts and positions is based on the rounded average.

	International staff						National staff			UNV			Total
	USG– ASG	D-2– D-1	P-5– P-4	P-3– P-2	FS	Subtotal	NPO	NGS	Subtotal	Inter- national	National	Subtotal	
<i>Civilian staff</i>													
Approved 2025/26	1	2	6	3	3	15	–	9	9	–	–	–	24
Proposed 2026/27	1	2	5	1	3	12	1	9	10	–	–	–	22
Net change	–	–	(1)	(2)	–	(3)	1	–	1	–	–	–	(2)

Estimated amount (civilian personnel)

(Thousands of United States dollars)

Approved 2025/26	4 023.8
Proposed 2026/27	3 399.5

^a Funded under general temporary assistance.**Component 1: substantive civilian**

<i>Category</i>	<i>Total</i>												
<i>I. United Nations police</i>													
Approved 2024/25													12
Actual 2024/25													2
Approved 2025/26													12
Proposed 2026/27													12
Net change													–
<i>II. Government-provided personnel</i>													
Approved 2024/25													10
Actual 2024/25													–
Approved 2025/26													10
Proposed 2026/27													10
Net change													–
	International staff						National staff			UNV			Total
	USG– ASG	D-2– D-1	P-5– P-4	P-3– P-2	FS	Subtotal	NPO	NGS	Subtotal	Inter- national	National	Subtotal	
<i>III. Civilian staff</i>													
Approved posts 2024/25	–	–	2	1	1	4	–	–	–	–	–	–	4
Actual posts 2024/25	–	–	1	1	1	3	–	–	–	–	–	–	3
Approved posts 2025/26	–	–	2	1	1	4	–	–	–	–	–	–	4
Proposed posts 2026/27	–	–	1	1	1	3	–	–	–	–	–	–	3
Net change	–	–	(1)	–	–	(1)	–	–	–	–	–	–	(1)
Subtotal, III													
Approved 2024/25	–	–	2	1	1	4	–	–	–	–	–	–	4
Actual 2024/25	–	–	1	1	1	3	–	–	–	–	–	–	3
Approved 2025/26	–	–	2	1	1	4	–	–	–	–	–	–	4
Proposed 2026/27	–	–	1	1	1	3	–	–	–	–	–	–	3
Net change	–	–	(1)	–	–	(1)	–	–	–	–	–	–	(1)

Total (I–III)	
Approved 2024/25	26
Actual 2024/25	5
Approved 2025/26	26
Proposed 2026/27	25
Net change	(1)
Estimated amount (civilian personnel)	
(Thousands of United States dollars)	
Approved 2025/26	920.8
Proposed 2026/27	610.6

Component 2: military

Category	Total												
<i>I. Military observers</i>													
Approved 2024/25	218												
Actual 2024/25	189												
Approved 2025/26	218												
Proposed 2026/27	218												
Net change	–												
<i>II. Military contingents</i>													
Approved 2024/25	27												
Actual 2024/25	26												
Approved 2025/26	27												
Proposed 2026/27	27												
Net change	–												
<i>III. Civilian staff</i>	<i>International staff</i>						<i>National staff</i>			<i>UNV</i>			<i>Total</i>
	<i>USG–ASG</i>	<i>D-2–D-1</i>	<i>P-5–P-4</i>	<i>P-3–P-2</i>	<i>FS</i>	<i>Subtotal</i>	<i>NPO</i>	<i>NGS</i>	<i>Subtotal</i>	<i>Inter-national</i>	<i>National</i>	<i>Subtotal</i>	
Approved posts 2024/25	–	1	–	–	1	2	–	–	–	–	–	–	2
Actual posts 2024/25	–	1	–	–	1	2	–	–	–	–	–	–	2
Approved posts 2025/26	–	1	–	–	1	2	–	–	–	–	–	–	2
Proposed posts 2026/27	–	1	–	–	1	2	–	–	–	–	–	–	2
Net change	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–
Subtotal, III													
Approved 2024/25	–	1	–	–	1	2	–	–	–	–	–	–	2
Actual 2024/25	–	1	–	–	1	2	–	–	–	–	–	–	2

Approved 2025/26	–	1	–	–	1	2	–	–	–	–	–	–	2
Proposed 2026/27	–	1	–	–	1	2	–	–	–	–	–	–	2
Net change	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–
Total (I–III)													
Approved 2024/25													247
Actual 2024/25													217
Approved 2025/26													247
Proposed 2026/27													247
Net change													–
Estimated amount (civilian personnel)													
(Thousands of United States dollars)													
Approved 2025/26													502.5
Proposed 2026/27													493.3

Component 3: support

	International staff						National staff			UNV			
Civilian staff	USG– ASG	D-2– D-1	P-5– P-4	P-3– P-2	FS	Subtotal	NPO	NGS	Subtotal	Inter- national	National	Subtotal	Total
Approved posts 2024/25	–	1	11	10	45	67	2	152	154	17	–	17	238
Actual posts 2024/25	–	1	10	9	41	61	2	140	142	14	–	14	217
Approved posts 2025/26	–	1	11	10	45	67	2	152	154	17	–	17	238
Proposed posts 2026/27	–	1	11	9	43	64	2	135	137	17	–	17	218
Net change	–	–	–	(1)	(2)	(3)	–	(17)	(17)	–	–	–	(20)
Total													
Approved 2024/25	–	1	11	10	45	67	2	152	154	17	–	17	238
Actual 2024/25	–	1	10	9	41	61	2	140	142	14	–	14	217
Approved 2025/26	–	1	11	10	45	67	2	152	154	17	–	17	238
Proposed 2026/27	–	1	11	9	43	64	2	135	137	17	–	17	218
Net change	–	–	–	(1)	(2)	(3)	–	(17)	(17)	–	–	–	(20)
Estimated amount (civilian personnel)													
(Thousands of United States dollars)													
Approved 2025/26													20 716.7
Proposed 2026/27													19 084.1

F. Proposed staffing changes

33. The proposed abolishment of three international posts (1 P-5 Senior Joint Operations Officer, 1 P-4 Joint Operations Officer and 1 P-3 Political Affairs Officer) is due to efficiency gains achieved through consolidating functions and partially reconfiguring responsibilities, aimed at maintaining mandate delivery while reducing staffing requirements. Under the revised organizational arrangements, core joint operations and political coordination functions are streamlined and integrated into existing structures, allowing for improved task distribution and enhanced

cross-functional collaboration. This reduces duplication and increases reliance on strengthened coordination mechanisms and senior-level oversight, eliminating the need for these posts.

34. A position of Programme Management Officer (P-4), funded under general temporary assistance, was established on 1 July 2022 to direct the implementation of the mine action programme in MINURSO. In view of the continuation of the programme in the 2026/27 period, it is proposed that the position be retained. The incumbent develops the strategy, leads operational planning and programme design, supports advocacy and oversees the performance of implementing partners.

35. Furthermore, the Mission proposes the nationalization of the Public Information Officer (P-3) post to an Associate Public Information Officer (National Professional Officer) post to strengthen national capacity in strategic communications. This nationalization of functions reflects the availability of qualified national expertise capable of performing the full range of responsibilities, including multilingual media monitoring, preparation of media highlights, social media debate monitoring to address misinformation and disinformation, and briefings to senior mission leadership.

36. The Mission also proposes the abolishment of 3 international posts (1 Human Resources Officer (P-3), 1 Transport Officer (Field Service) and 1 Telecommunications Officer (Field Service)) and 17 national General Service posts within mission support components, several of which have been vacant for a prolonged period. The functions previously performed by these posts are streamlined, redistributed and absorbed within existing mission support capacities through revised workflows and internal reorganization, allowing the Mission to maintain effective support services while aligning staffing levels with actual operational requirements.

Human resources: proposed changes

Component/office/section/unit	Type	Number	Level	Functional title	Post action	From/to
Executive direction and management						
Office of the Special Representative of the Secretary-General/Mine Action Service						
Temporary position	International	1	P-4	Programme Management Officer	Continuation	
Net change		–				
Office of the Special Representative of the Secretary-General						
Post	International	(1)	P-4	Joint Operations Officer	Abolishment	
	International	(1)	P-3	Public Information Officer	Conversion	
	National	1	NPO	Associate Public Information Officer	Conversion	
Net change		(1)				
Tindouf Liaison Office						
Post	International	(1)	P-3	Political Affairs Officer	Abolishment	
Net change		(1)				
Net change, executive direction and management		(2)				

Component/office/section/unit	Type	Number	Level	Functional title	Post action	From/to
Component 1						
Political Affairs Section						
Post	International	(1)	P-5	Senior Joint Operations Officer	Abolishment	
Net change		(1)				
Net change, component 1		(1)				
Component 3						
Human Resources Section						
Post	International	(1)	P-3	Human Resources Officer	Abolishment	
Net change		(1)				
Field Technology Section						
Post	International	(1)	FS	Telecommunications Officer	Abolishment	
	National	(1)	NGS	Telecommunications Assistant	Abolishment	
	National	(1)	NGS	Telecommunications Technical Assistant	Abolishment	
Net change		(3)				
Engineering Section						
Post	National	(1)	NGS	Engineering Assistant	Abolishment	
	National	(1)	NGS	Administrative Assistant	Abolishment	
	National	(1)	NGS	Heating, Ventilation and Air Conditioning Assistant	Abolishment	
	National	(1)	NGS	Generator Mechanic	Abolishment	
Net change		(4)				
Transport Section						
Post	International	(1)	FS	Transport Officer	Abolishment	
	National	(1)	NGS	Administrative Assistant	Abolishment	
	National	(4)	NGS	Vehicle Technician	Abolishment	
	National	(2)	NGS	Heavy Vehicle Operator	Abolishment	
Net change		(8)				
Procurement Section						
Post	National	(1)	NGS	Procurement Assistant	Abolishment	
Net change		(1)				
Centralized Warehousing Unit						
Post	National	(1)	NGS	Supply Assistant	Abolishment	
	National	(1)	NGS	Logistics Assistant	Abolishment	
Net change		(2)				
Acquisition Management Section						
Post	National	(1)	NGS	Contract Management Assistant	Abolishment	
Net change		(1)				

<i>Component/office/section/unit</i>	<i>Type</i>	<i>Number</i>	<i>Level</i>	<i>Functional title</i>	<i>Post action</i>	<i>From/to</i>
Net change, component 3		(20)				
Total		(23)				

G. Results-based budgeting frameworks²

Component 1: substantive civilian

<i>Expected accomplishment</i>	<i>Indicators of achievement</i>
1.1 Create a conducive environment to achieving progress towards political settlement of the final status of Western Sahara	1.1.1 The Personal Envoy of the Secretary-General will provide briefings to the Security Council on activities and developments in relation to the Mission's area of responsibility (2022/23: 2; 2023/24: 2; 2024/25: 2; 2025/26: 2; 2026/27: 2)
1.2 The Office of the United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees-led confidence-building measures programme is currently on hold. Once resumed, the expected accomplishment will concern progress towards the resolution of humanitarian issues, in particular those related to refugees	1.2.1 Resume refugee family visits (1-way trips) (2022/23: programme remains on hold; 2023/24: programme remains on hold; 2024/25: programme remains on hold; 2025/26: programme may remain on hold; 2026/27: programme may remain on hold)
1.3 Reduced threat posed by landmines and explosive ordnance, improving security and accessibility within the Territory	1.3.1 Percentage of patrols undertaken by MINURSO military observers without explosive ordnance incidents (2022/23: 100 per cent; 2023/24: 100 per cent; 2024/25: 100 per cent; 2025/26: 100 per cent; 2026/27: 100 per cent) 1.3.2 Additional square metres of surface and subsurface area free of known threats of landmines and explosive ordnance in order to facilitate the monitoring of the ceasefire and to ensure safe passage for United Nations personnel (2022/23: 104,024 m ² of surface and subsurface area; 2023/24: 3.5 million m ² of surface and subsurface area; 2024/25: 5 million m ² of surface and subsurface area; 2025/26: 5 million m ² of surface and subsurface area; 2026/27: 3 million m ² of surface and subsurface area)
<i>External factors</i>	
Collaboration from the parties to the conflict is essential, and any negative change in the security landscape that could disrupt the planned demining efforts may necessitate the suspension of such activities. In addition, the resumption of hostilities exacerbates the already substantial threat posed by existing explosive hazards	

² The results-based budgeting outputs are available for consultation on the Umoja Analytics platform as part of efforts to streamline the volume of information presented in the new combined budget and performance report.

Component 2: military

<i>Expected accomplishment</i>	<i>Indicators of achievement</i>
2.1 Cessation of hostilities	2.1.1 Agreement and compliance of the parties with a cessation of hostilities 2.1.2 No serious violations of ceasefire and military agreements (2022/23: 0; 2023/24: 0; 2024/25: 0; 2025/26: 0; 2026/27: 0)

External factors

Willingness of the parties to facilitate and maintain the freedom of movement of military observers. Change in the political or security situation, which could lead to a lack of observation, monitoring and investigation capabilities and a change in the Mission's overall operational tempo

Component 3: support

<i>Expected accomplishment</i>	<i>Indicators of achievement</i>
3.1 Rapid, effective, efficient and responsible support services for the Mission	3.1.1 Average annual percentage of women international civilian staff (2022/23: 27.0 per cent; 2023/24: 25.9 per cent; 2024/25: 27.0 per cent; 2025/26 $\geq$ 28.0 per cent; 2026/27 $\geq$ 28.0 per cent) 3.1.2 Average number of days for roster recruitments, from posting of the job opening to candidate selection, for international candidates (2022/23: 38; 2023/24: 59; 2024/25: 145; 2025/26 $\leq$ 86; 2026/27 $\leq$ 65) 3.1.3 Average number of days for post-specific recruitments, from posting of the job opening to candidate selection, for international candidates (2022/23: 244; 2023/24: 392; 2024/25: 385; 2025/26 $\leq$ 126; 2026/27 $\leq$ 120) 3.1.4 Overall score on the property management index based on 20 underlying key performance indicators (2022/23: 1,634; 2023/24: 1,700; 2024/25: 1,860; 2025/26 $\geq$ 1,800; 2026/27 $\geq$ 1,800) 3.1.5 Percentage of contingent personnel in standard-compliant United Nations accommodations at 30 June, in accordance with memorandums of understanding (2022/23: 100 per cent; 2023/24: 100 per cent; 2024/25: 100 per cent; 2025/26: 100 per cent; 2026/27: 100 per cent) 3.1.6 Compliance of vendors with United Nations rations standards for delivery, quality and stock management (2022/23: 70.0 per cent; 2023/24: 98.5 per cent; 2024/25: 99.0 per cent; 2025/26 $\geq$ 98.0 per cent; 2026/27 $\geq$ 98.0 per cent)

External factors

Parties to the conflict will continue to allow the freedom of movement of mission personnel. Suppliers will supply goods and services, as contracted

Evaluation activities

37. During the 2024/25 period, the Office of Internal Oversight Services conducted an evaluation of MINURSO (IED-24-020) in accordance with General Assembly resolution [48/218](#) B. Following that evaluation, a review was undertaken of the deployment of United Nations military observers at team sites east of the berm. The review was aimed at ensuring an optimal balance between prevailing movement restrictions in this part of the Territory and the operational requirements necessary for the continued delivery of monitoring, observation and investigation activities at these locations.

38. No evaluation is planned for the 2026/27 period.

II. Financial resources

A. Overall

(Thousands of United States dollars; budget year is from 1 July to 30 June)

Category	Variance							
	2024/25 apportionment	2024/25 expenditure	Variance		2025/26 apportionment	2026/27 cost estimates	Variance	
			Unencumbered balance	Percentage			Amount	Percentage
	(1)	(2)	(3)=(1)-(2)	(4)=(3)÷(1)	(5)	(6)	(7)=(6)-(5)	(8)=(7÷5)
Military and police personnel								
Military observers	6 449.8	7 223.3	(773.5)	(12.0)	7 722.5	6 954.5	(768.0)	(9.9)
Military contingents	896.7	1 027.4	(130.7)	(14.6)	1 061.2	110.1	(951.1)	(89.6)
United Nations police	78.6	69.8	8.8	11.2	95.8	—	(95.8)	(100.0)
Formed police units	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
Subtotal	7 425.1	8 320.5	(895.4)	(12.1)	8 879.5	7 064.6	(1 814.9)	(20.4)
Civilian personnel								
International staff	17 278.8	16 852.7	426.1	2.5	18 141.7	16 108.3	(2 033.4)	(11.2)
National Professional Officer	287.8	230.8	57.0	19.8	288.6	371.6	83.0	28.8
National General Service staff	6 691.6	6 892.1	(200.5)	(3.0)	6 694.1	6 145.0	(549.1)	(8.2)
United Nations Volunteers	795.4	923.8	(128.4)	(16.1)	806.6	732.0	(74.6)	(9.2)
General temporary assistance	248.2	258.1	(9.9)	(4.0)	265.6	263.4	(2.2)	(0.8)
Government-provided personnel	32.9	—	32.9	100.0	—	—	—	—
Subtotal	25 334.7	25 157.5	177.2	0.7	26 196.6	23 620.3	(2 576.3)	(9.8)
Operational costs								
Civilian electoral observers	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
Consultants and consulting services	48.8	4.9	43.9	90.0	14.8	14.8	—	—
Official travel	521.8	350.4	171.4	32.8	579.6	545.9	(33.7)	(5.8)
Facilities and infrastructure	5 305.3	3 656.1	1 649.2	31.1	5 525.4	5 138.3	(387.1)	(7.0)
Ground transportation	1 757.8	1 306.0	451.8	25.7	2 136.1	1 491.5	(644.6)	(30.2)
Air operations	20 175.0	18 619.1	1 555.9	7.7	17 887.8	16 137.8	(1 750.0)	(9.8)
Marine operations	95.0	9.3	85.7	90.2	57.0	32.4	(24.6)	(43.2)
Communications and information technology	2 796.0	2 500.7	295.3	10.6	3 252.3	3 125.6	(126.7)	(3.9)
Medical	263.4	145.6	117.8	44.7	221.4	217.1	(4.3)	(1.9)
Special equipment	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
Other supplies, services and equipment	5 068.2	4 662.3	405.9	8.0	5 943.6	5 321.0	(622.6)	(10.5)
Quick-impact projects	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
Subtotal	36 031.3	31 254.4	4 776.9	13.3	35 618.0	32 024.4	(3 593.6)	(10.1)
Gross requirements	68 791.1	64 732.4	4 058.7	5.9	70 694.1	62 709.3	(7 984.8)	(11.3)
Staff assessment income	2 849.0	2 978.3	(129.3)	(4.5)	3 095.2	2 865.2	(230.0)	(7.4)
Net requirements	65 942.1	61 754.1	4 188.0	6.4	67 598.9	59 844.1	(7 754.8)	(11.5)
Voluntary contributions in kind (budgeted) ^a	519.0	217.0	302.0	58.2	519.0	519.0	—	—
Total requirements	69 310.1	64 949.4	4 360.7	6.3	71 213.1	63 228.3	(7 984.8)	(11.2)

^a Cost estimates for 2026/27 are inclusive of \$235,000 from the Government of Morocco and \$284,000 from the Government of Algeria.

B. Non-budgeted contributions

39. The value of non-budgeted contributions for the period from 1 July 2024 to 30 June 2025 and from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027 is as follows:

(Thousands of United States dollars)

<i>Category</i>	<i>Actual value (2024/25)</i>	<i>Estimated value (2026/27)</i>
Status-of-mission agreement ^a	3 737.2	3 737.2
Voluntary contributions in kind (non-budgeted)	—	—
Total	3 737.2	3 737.2

^a Includes facilities and infrastructure and waived landing fees for aircraft.

C. Efficiency gains

40. The cost estimates for the period from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027 take into account the following efficiency initiatives:

(Thousands of United States dollars)

<i>Budget class</i>	<i>Description of the initiative</i>	<i>Estimated efficiency gains (2024/25)</i>	<i>Realized efficiency gains (2024/25)</i>	<i>Variance (2024/25)</i>	<i>Investment since inception to generate the efficiency gains of 2026/27</i>	<i>Cumulated efficiency gains since inception and before 2026/27</i>	<i>Estimated efficiency gains (2026/27)</i>	<i>Cumulated investment and efficiency gains as of 2026/27</i>
		(1)	(2)	(3)=(2)-(1)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)=(4)+(5)+(6)
Military contingent	Replacement of troop-contributing countries medical support with civilian medical services (estimated savings)	—	—	—	—	—	499.5	499.5
Civilian personnel	Nationalization of post	—	—	—	—	—	131.7	131.7
Civilian personnel	Abolishment of 6 international posts and 17 national General Service posts	—	—	—	—	—	2 035.4	2 035.4
Facilities and infrastructure	Replacement of diesel-generated power with a solar-diesel hybrid power system, which is expected to reduce the quantity of diesel fuel consumed by the generators by 90 per cent	253.0	500.0	247.0	(3 766.0)	1 100.0	600.0	(2 066.0)

Budget class	Description of the initiative	Estimated efficiency gains (2024/25)	Realized efficiency gains (2024/25)	Variance (2024/25)	Investment since inception to generate the efficiency gains of 2026/27	Cumulated efficiency gains since inception and before 2026/27	Estimated efficiency gains (2026/27)	Cumulated investment and efficiency gains as of 2026/27
		(1)	(2)	(3)=(2)-(1)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)=(4)+(5)+(6)
Facilities and infrastructure	Transfer of assets from MINUSMA (cost avoidance)	—	—	—	—	—	92.9	92.9
Communications and information technology	Transfer of assets from MINUSMA (cost avoidance)	—	157.2	157.2	—	—	—	—
Air operations	Termination of the rotary-wing aircraft, including aviation fuel, and 1 fixed-wing	—	—	—	—	3 223.5	1 787.9	5 011.5
Total		253.0	657.2	404.2	(3 766.0)	4 323.5	5 147.4	5 704.9
Approved budget for 2025/26						70 694.1		
2026/27 estimated efficiencies as a percentage of the approved budget for 2025/26						7.3		

Abbreviation: MINUSMA, United Nations Multidimensional Integrated Stabilization Mission in Mali.

D. Unencumbered balance

41. The unencumbered balance for the periods from 2022/23 to 2024/25 as reported in the respective performance reports is as follows:

Trend of the unencumbered balance

(Thousands of United States dollars)

Group	Amount		
	2022/23	2023/24	2024/25
Military and police personnel	78.7	(908.9)	(895.4)
Civilian personnel	1 537.4	(2 333.2)	177.2
Operational costs	1 113.1	3 592.2	4 776.9
Total	2 729.2	350.1	4 058.7

E. Cancellation of prior-period obligations

42. Prior-period obligations for the periods from 2022/23 to 2024/25 were cancelled as follows:

Trend of the cancellation of prior-period obligations

(Thousands of United States dollars)

<i>Group</i>	<i>Amount</i>		
	<i>2022/23</i>	<i>2023/24</i>	<i>2024/25</i>
Military and police personnel	118.6	259.5	135.8
Civilian personnel	20.2	164.0	50.7
Operational costs	386.6	960.1	667.2
Total	525.4	1 383.6	853.7

Note: The amounts represent the total obligations that were cancelled at the end of the 12-month period following the end of the budget period in respect of goods supplied and services rendered in the budget period, and at the end of an additional period of four years in respect of obligations to troop- and police-contributing countries.

F. Other revenue and adjustments, and borrowing**1. Other revenue and adjustments**

(Thousands of United States dollars)

<i>Category</i>	<i>Amount</i>
Investment revenue	7.4
Other/miscellaneous revenue ^a	56.4
Voluntary contributions in cash	—
Prior-period adjustments	—
Cancellation of prior-period obligations	853.7
Total	917.5

^a Breakdown of other/miscellaneous revenue: refund of prior-period expenses (\$500); and other revenue (\$55,900).

43. Credits comprising the unencumbered balances, other revenue and the cancellation of prior-period obligations reduce the assessed contributions owed by Member States in the following financial year. The credit for the 2024/25 period for overall peacekeeping operations amounts to \$335.5 million, including the support entities and the United Nations Multidimensional Integrated Stabilization Mission in Mali (MINUSMA). In the current financial situation, offsetting this large amount of credit against a future assessment for the 2026/27 period will reduce the collection and undermine the ability of peacekeeping operations to fully implement their mandates. Accordingly, the Secretary-General proposes that the General Assembly approve that the credits in respect of the financial period 2024/25 be placed in a reserve that would be used in the event that collections are insufficient to enable the implementation of those mandates and allow Member States to apply their share towards current or future dues once the Assembly determines that the liquidity situation has sufficiently improved. This proposal is explained in more detail in the peacekeeping overview report.

2. Borrowing

44. Owing to its cash liquidity situation, the Mission received loans from the Peacekeeping Reserve Fund and other active peacekeeping missions in the performance period as follows:

(Millions of United States dollars)

<i>As at</i>	<i>Lending mission</i>	<i>Amount</i>
31 July 2024	UNIFIL (5.9), UNDOF (3.4), MONUSCO (7.1)	16.4
31 August 2024	Peacekeeping Reserve Fund (11.7), UNDOF (3.4)	15.1
30 September 2024	Peacekeeping Reserve Fund	11.7
31 October 2024	Peacekeeping Reserve Fund	6.1
30 November 2024	Peacekeeping Reserve Fund	11.1
31 December 2024	Peacekeeping Reserve Fund	11.1
31 January 2025	Peacekeeping Reserve Fund	11.1
28 February 2025	Peacekeeping Reserve Fund	11.1
31 March 2025	Peacekeeping Reserve Fund	11.1
30 April 2025	Peacekeeping Reserve Fund	11.1
31 May 2025	Peacekeeping Reserve Fund (11.1), UNDOF (4.5)	15.6
30 June 2025	Peacekeeping Reserve Fund (11.1), UNDOF (6.5), UNIFIL (2.4)	20.0

Abbreviations: MONUSCO, United Nations Organization Stabilization Mission in the Democratic Republic of the Congo; UNDOF, United Nations Disengagement Observer Force; UNIFIL, United Nations Interim Force in Lebanon.

G. Vacancy factors

45. The cost estimates for the period from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027 take into account the vacancy factors outlined in the table below. The table also summarizes, by category, the actual rates in the periods from 2022/23 to 2024/25, as well as the approved and current rates for the 2025/26 period.

(Percentage)

Category	Actual			2025/26 approved	Actual as at 31 December 2025	Actual average, January to December 2025	2026/27 proposed
	2022/23	2023/24	2024/25				
Military and police personnel							
Military observers	10.1	9.6	13.3	8.3	31.7	24.8	23.4
Military contingents	(3.7)	—	3.7	—	18.5	7.4	92.6
United Nations police	83.3	83.3	83.3	83.3	100.0	91.7	100.0
Formed police units	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
Civilian personnel							
International staff	13.1	10.3	11.5	9.2	18.4	14.9	11.3
National staff							
National Professional Officers	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
National General Service staff	7.5	7.5	8.1	8.1	18.0	8.7	8.3
United Nations Volunteers							
International	41.2	11.8	17.6	11.8	29.4	23.5	23.5
National	—	—	—	—	—	—	—

Category	Actual			2025/26 approved	Actual as at 31 December 2025	Actual average, January to December 2025	2026/27 proposed
	2022/23	2023/24	2024/25				
Temporary positions ^a							
International staff	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
National Professional Officers	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
National General Service staff	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
Government-provided personnel	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0

^a Funded under general temporary assistance.

46. The vacancy factors take into account the high number of abolishments included in the proposed budget for 2026/27. Accordingly, the proposed vacancy rates for civilian personnel categories with abolishments were estimated using the total number of vacant posts and positions as at 31 December 2025, net of the number of posts and positions proposed for abolishment. For categories without proposed abolishments, the standard policy guidance was applied, using either the 12-month average vacancy rate from January to December 2025 or the actual vacancy rate as at 31 December 2025. For military and police personnel, the vacancy factors reflect their planned deployment during the period. This approach ensures that vacancy rates are based on, to the extent possible, the actual data while maintaining consistency across the proposed budgets. A vacancy rate of 50 per cent has been applied in the calculation of costs for the proposed conversions.

H. Analysis of requirements for air operations

47. The flight hour utilization rates for the periods from 2022/23 to 2024/25, the approved and proposed number of flight hours for the 2025/26 and 2026/27 periods, respectively, and the number of flight hours calculated on the basis of the policy guidance³ are as follows:

Aircraft type	Flight hour utilization (percentage)				Flight hours				Variance
	Actual			Average (2022/23 to 2024/25)	Approved		Policy	Proposed	
	2022/23	2023/24	2024/25		2024/25	2025/26	2026/27	2026/27	
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	
Fixed-wing	118.7	109.0	127.5	118.4	1 008	1 220	1 008	840	(380)
Helicopters	24.9	58.0	56.7	46.5	2 115	1 422	1 199	1 199	(223)
Total					3 123	2 642	2 207	2 039	(603)

³ For missions that utilized less than 90 per cent of the approved flight hours, the proposed flight hours are based on the higher of the average utilization percentage of the three most recent performance periods, as shown in the table above, and the utilization percentage of the most recent period (2024/25). The higher of those two percentages is then applied to the number of flight hours approved for the most recent performance period (2024/25) to obtain the proposed flight hours. Limited exceptions to this guidance may be considered on a case-by-case basis, should compelling justifications be provided. To provide missions with flexibility for their operating environment, total flight hours according to the policy may be distributed between the categories as required by the mission. A delayed deployment of 50 per cent is applied for new aircraft, with exceptions considered for the significant reconfiguration of an aviation fleet.

48. The Mission's fixed-wing aircraft will be reduced from two to one while two rotary-wing aircraft will be maintained, with the aim of enhancing operational efficiency and facilitating the movement of personnel and life support items across the mission area. The efficiency is achieved through optimization of air schedules, consolidation of United Nations military observers' movements and more reliance on ground transportation both west of the berm and to the team sites east of the berm as ground convoys become a regular activity. The proposed deployment takes into account the unique local environment, and movement restrictions, which make air assets the only efficient transportation mode to certain locations. The number of aircraft and flight hours are in line with the policy guidance and based on the Mission's pattern of flight utilization. The lower rate of flight utilization for helicopters can be attributed to the resumption of conflict in Western Sahara in November 2020 and the reprioritization of funds in light of the ongoing liquidity challenges.

I. Programmatic activities

49. The estimated resource requirements for programmatic activities for the period from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027, compared with previous periods, are as follows:

(Thousands of United States dollars)

<i>Category</i>	<i>2024/25 apportionment</i>	<i>2024/25 expenditure</i>	<i>2026/27 cost estimates</i>	<i>Related expected accomplishment</i>
Mine detection and mine clearing services	2 991.3	2 975.5	2 998.8	1.3
Total	2 991.3	2 975.5	2 998.8	

50. Detailed information on programmatic activities undertaken during the 2024/25 period, as well as on activities planned for the 2026/27 period, is provided in the supplementary information.

III. Analysis of variances⁴

	<i>2024/25 variance</i>		<i>2026/27 variance</i>	
Military observers	(\$773.5)	(12.0%)	(\$768.0)	(9.9%)

51. For the 2024/25 period, the increased requirements were attributable primarily to a higher actual mission subsistence allowance rate, effective 1 January 2025, compared with the budgeted rate. The increased requirements were offset in part by: (a) a higher vacancy rate of 13.3 per cent, compared with 11.5 per cent in the approved budget; and (b) the lower number of claims associated with the shipment of personal effects entitlement.

52. For the 2026/27 period, the reduced requirements are attributable primarily to the application of a higher vacancy rate of 23.4 per cent, compared with 8.3 per cent applied in the approved budget, offset in part by the provision for mobilization costs arising from the anticipated expiration of the current rations contract during the 2025/26 period.

⁴ Resource variance amounts are expressed in thousands of United States dollars. Analysis is provided for variances of at least plus or minus 5 per cent or \$100,000.

	<i>2024/25 variance</i>		<i>2026/27 variance</i>	
Military contingents	(\$130.7)	(14.6%)	(\$951.1)	(89.6%)

53. For the 2024/25 period, the increased requirements were attributable primarily to the lower actual adjustment against the standard troop reimbursement for the deployment of non-functional or absent contingent-owned major equipment compared with the budget estimate.

54. For the 2026/27 period, the reduced requirements are attributable primarily to: (a) the non-deployment of a medical military contingent, owing to improved local medical infrastructure and internal medical capacity, enabling the use of commercial medical services and resulting in greater cost-efficiency while maintaining quality care; and (b) the application of a higher vacancy rate of 71.4 per cent for military staff officers, compared with the non-application of a vacancy rate in the approved budget.

	<i>2024/25 variance</i>		<i>2026/27 variance</i>	
United Nations police	\$8.8	11.2%	(\$95.8)	(100.0%)

55. For the 2024/25 period, the reduced requirements were attributable primarily to the delay in deployment of one United Nations police officer.

56. For the 2026/27 period, the reduced requirements are attributable primarily to the non-deployment of United Nations police officers, following a reassessment of operational requirements and support modalities.

	<i>2024/25 variance</i>		<i>2026/27 variance</i>	
International staff	\$426.1	2.5%	(\$2 033.4)	(11.2%)

57. For the 2024/25 period, the reduced requirements were attributable primarily to: (a) a lower actual common staff cost as a percentage of actual salary costs compared with the budgeted percentage; and (b) the higher actual vacancy rate of 11.5 per cent, compared with the rate of 9.2 per cent applied in the approved budget. The reduction in requirements was offset in part by the higher salary rates compared with the rates applied in the approved budget.

58. For the 2026/27 period, the reduced requirements are attributable primarily to the application of a higher vacancy rate of 11.3 per cent, compared with 9.2 per cent in the approved budget, the abolishment of six posts and the nationalization of one international post. The reduced requirements are offset in part by the application of higher salary rates based on the revised scale compared with the rates applied in the approved budget for the 2025/26 period.

	<i>2024/25 variance</i>		<i>2026/27 variance</i>	
National Professional Officer	\$57.0	19.8%	\$83.0	28.8%

59. For the 2024/25 period, the reduced requirements were attributable primarily to the temporary assignment of one National Professional Officer to MINUSMA. The reduced requirements were offset in part by a higher revised salary scale effective December 2024.

60. For the 2026/27 period, the increased requirements are attributable primarily to: (a) the application of the exchange rate of 9.24 Moroccan dirhams to the United States dollar, compared with the rate of 10.004 Moroccan dirhams to the United States dollar applied for the 2025/26 period; and (b) the increase of one National Professional Officer resulting from the nationalization of one P-3 post, contributing to a cost-efficient staffing structure, with application of a vacancy rate of 50 per cent.

	<i>2024/25 variance</i>		<i>2026/27 variance</i>	
National General Service staff	(\$200.5)	(3.0%)	(\$549.1)	(8.2%)

61. For the 2024/25 period, the increased requirements were attributable primarily to the higher salary rates based on the revised salary scale, effective December 2024, compared with the rates applied in the approved budget.

62. For the 2026/27 period, the reduced requirements are attributable primarily to the abolishment of 17 national General Service posts. The reduced requirements are offset in part by the application of the exchange rate of 9.24 Moroccan dirhams to the United States dollar, compared with the rate of 10.004 Moroccan dirhams to the United States dollar applied for the 2025/26 period.

	<i>2024/25 variance</i>		<i>2026/27 variance</i>	
United Nations Volunteers	(\$128.4)	(16.1%)	(\$74.6)	(9.2%)

63. For the 2024/25 period, the increased requirements were attributable primarily to the delayed processing of payments for the prior period. The increased requirements were offset in part by the higher actual vacancy rate of 17.6 per cent, compared with the rate of 11.8 per cent applied in the approved budget.

64. For the 2026/27 period, the reduced requirements are attributable primarily to the application of a higher vacancy rate of 23.5 per cent, compared with 11.8 per cent in the approved budget for the 2025/26 period.

	<i>2024/25 variance</i>		<i>2026/27 variance</i>	
General temporary assistance	(\$9.9)	(4.0%)	(\$2.2)	(0.8%)

65. For the 2024/25 period, the increased requirements were attributable primarily to the higher salary rates compared with the rates applied in the approved budget.

	<i>2024/25 variance</i>		<i>2026/27 variance</i>	
Government-provided personnel	\$32.9	100.0%	—	—

66. For the 2024/25 period, the reduced requirements were attributable primarily to the non-deployment of government-provided personnel.

	<i>2024/25 variance</i>		<i>2026/27 variance</i>	
Consultants and consulting services	\$43.9	90.0%	—	—

67. For the 2024/25 period, reduced requirements were attributable primarily to the reprioritization of resources in light of the ongoing liquidity challenges.

	<i>2024/25 variance</i>		<i>2026/27 variance</i>	
Official travel	\$171.4	32.8%	(\$33.7)	(5.8%)

68. For the 2024/25 period, the reduced requirements were attributable primarily to liquidity challenges, which led to: (a) a lower number of trips than budgeted, as official travel was curtailed as part of austerity measures; and (b) the cancellation of planned travel for training, as online training sessions were prioritized.

69. For the 2026/27 period, the reduced requirements are attributable primarily to the lower number of trips, as staff members are expected to participate in conferences and meetings remotely, compared with the travel included in the approved budget.

	2024/25 variance		2026/27 variance	
Facilities and infrastructure	\$1 649.2	31.1%	(\$387.1)	(7.0%)

70. For the 2024/25 period, the reduced requirements were attributable primarily to a reprioritization of funds to meet the increased requirements for uniformed personnel, as well as the following: (a) a lower actual volume of diesel fuel of 0.2 million litres, compared with the budgeted volume of 0.5 million litres, due to the commissioning of a solar-diesel hybrid power system; (b) delays in finalizing a service contract for supporting United Nations military observers team sites east of the berm; (c) the cancellation of the acquisition of prefabricated facilities, water pumps and water tanks; (d) the postponement of the renovation of dining and kitchen facilities at the Awsard and Oum Dreyga team sites, as well as the construction of a generator and fuel tank house at the mission logistics base; and (e) acquisition of less equipment and fewer supplies compared with the budgeted estimates.

71. For the 2026/27 period, the reduced requirements are attributable primarily to: (a) the non-acquisition of equipment owing to the transfer of equipment from MINUSMA; and (b) the lower projected volume of diesel fuel compared with the budgeted volume. The reduced requirements are offset in part by the need to replace obsolete gelled lead-acid batteries in the photovoltaic solar systems with more efficient and advanced lithium battery technology, including the associated cabling and installation components.

	2024/25 variance		2026/27 variance	
Ground transportation	\$451.8	25.7%	(\$644.6)	(30.2%)

72. For the 2024/25 period, the reduced requirements were attributable primarily to: (a) a lower actual volume of diesel fuel of 0.3 million litres, compared with the budgeted volume of 0.4 million litres; and (b) the non-acquisition of 15 vehicles, for which a provision was included in the approved budget, owing to the liquidity challenges.

73. For the 2026/27 period, reduced requirements are attributable primarily to: (a) the lower number of replacement vehicles compared with the 2025/26 approved budget to prioritize the replacement of vehicles and trucks used for convoy operations to enhance personnel safety; and (b) the lower estimated average price and volume of fuel for vehicles compared with the price and volume in the approved budget for 2025/26.

	2024/25 variance		2026/27 variance	
Air operations	\$1 555.9	7.7%	(\$1 750.0)	(9.8%)

74. For the 2024/25 period, the reduced requirements were attributable primarily to the reconfiguration of the rotary-wing fleet through the reduction of one light utility helicopter (Bell 412) owing to the reprioritization of funds in light of the ongoing liquidity challenges.

75. For the 2026/27 period, the reduced requirements are attributable primarily to: (a) the reconfiguration of the fixed-wing fleet by reducing one light utility passenger aircraft (Let 410), owing to operational adjustments and the optimization of fleet utilization; (b) the termination of one set of standby helicopter crew in Smara, through optimization of the services; and (c) the lower estimated average price and volume of fuel for aviation compared with the price and volume in the approved budget for 2025/26, due to reduced operational requirements. The reduced requirements are offset in part by the planned acquisition of one Jet A1 fuel truck, which is needed to ensure the safe and timely refuelling of the Mission's aviation assets, support

continuous air operations and maintain compliance with operational and safety standards.

	<i>2024/25 variance</i>		<i>2026/27 variance</i>	
Marine operations	\$85.7	90.2%	(\$24.6)	(43.2%)

76. For the 2024/25 period, the reduced requirements were attributable primarily to the acquisition of fewer sea containers than budgeted owing to the lower acquisition of equipment.

77. For the 2026/27 period, the reduced requirements are attributable primarily to the lower number of sea containers for transporting equipment compared with the number included in the 2025/26 approved budget, due to the lower acquisition of equipment.

	<i>2024/25 variance</i>		<i>2026/27 variance</i>	
Communications and information technology	\$295.3	10.6%	(\$126.7)	(3.9%)

78. For the 2024/25 period, the reduced requirements were attributable primarily to: (a) the austerity measures established to manage liquidity challenges resulting in the delayed or postponed acquisition of computing devices and communication shelters; and (b) the non-acquisition of equipment owing to the transfer of equipment from MINUSMA.

79. For the 2026/27 period, the reduced requirements are attributable primarily to the lower mission share of the cost of centralized support services, including charges for transponders and leased lines, and the lower cost of software and licences.

	<i>2024/25 variance</i>		<i>2026/27 variance</i>	
Medical	\$117.8	44.7%	(\$4.3)	(1.9%)

80. For the 2024/25 period, the reduced requirements were attributable primarily to: (a) a lower-than-anticipated cost compared with budgeted estimates due to the absence of medical evacuations outside the mission area; and (b) the non-acquisition of supplies for which a provision was included in the approved budget, due to the reprioritization of funds.

	<i>2024/25 variance</i>		<i>2026/27 variance</i>	
Other supplies, services and equipment	\$405.9	8.0%	(\$622.6)	(10.5%)

81. For the 2024/25 period, the reduced requirements were attributable primarily to lower-than-budgeted freight costs, which resulted from the cancellation of equipment and supply acquisition, including prefabricated facilities, water pumps, water tanks, vehicles, computing devices and communication shelters, owing to the reprioritization of resources in light of liquidity challenges.

82. For the 2026/27 period, the reduced requirements are attributable primarily to: (a) the absence of mobilization and initial equipment costs included in the approved 2025/26 budget, associated with the onboarding of a new partner under the Mine Action Service; and (b) lower other freight and related costs resulting from the acquisition of a reduced number of assets requiring shipment.

IV. Actions to be taken by the General Assembly

83. The actions to be taken by the General Assembly in connection with the financing of MINURSO are:

(a) To take note of the unencumbered balance of \$4,058,700 with respect to the period from 1 July 2024 to 30 June 2025;

(b) To take note of other revenue for the period ended 30 June 2025 amounting to \$917,500 from investment revenue (\$7,400), other/miscellaneous revenue (\$56,400) and the cancellation of prior-period obligations (\$853,700);

(c) To approve the apportionment of the amount of \$4,976,200 among Member States in accordance with the applicable scale of assessment for 2025 and to place such apportioned amount in a reserve that would be used in the event that collections are insufficient to enable the full, efficient and effective implementation of mandates;

(d) To allow Member States to apply their share of the amount apportioned in subparagraph (c) above towards current or future dues once the General Assembly determines that the liquidity situation has improved sufficiently to allow such application;

(e) To appropriate the amount of \$62,709,300 for the maintenance of the Mission for the 12-month period from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027;

(f) To assess the amount in subparagraph (e) above at a monthly rate of \$5,225,775 should the Security Council decide to continue the mandate of the Mission.

V. Summary of follow-up action taken to implement the decisions and requests of the General Assembly in its resolutions 76/274 and 79/310, including the requests and recommendations of the Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions endorsed by the Assembly

A. General Assembly

Cross-cutting issues

(Resolution 76/274)

<i>Decision/request</i>	<i>Action taken to implement decision/request</i>
Requests the Secretary-General to improve comprehensive oversight of the activities of peacekeeping missions and implement the recommendations of relevant oversight bodies in this regard to avoid deficiencies in management and related economic losses, with the aim of ensuring full compliance with the Financial Regulations and Rules of the United Nations (para. 17).	As at 31 December 2025, 14 of the 15 recommendations (93 per cent) issued by the Office of Internal Oversight Services and 13 of the 22 recommendations (59 per cent) issued by the Board of Auditors were implemented. Regular follow-ups are undertaken to ensure the timely closure of the remaining recommendations.

<i>Decision/request</i>	<i>Action taken to implement decision/request</i>
Requests that future budget proposals demonstrate the scalability of mission support components, including their staffing and operational costs, be proportionate in relation to the changing level of other mission components and include standard indicators (para. 27).	The mission support ratio (the total number of mission support and security personnel per 1,000 total mission personnel) in the 2025/26 period is 444.9, higher than 441.5 in the 2020/21 period.
Requests the Secretary-General to consider options for greater nationalization of functions when formulating budget submissions, commensurate with mission mandates and requirements where applicable (para. 34).	MINURSO proposes the nationalization of 1 P-3 post to a National Professional Officer in 2026/27. The Mission is preparing for the civilian staffing review in 2026.

B. Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions

Financing of the United Nations Mission for the Referendum in Western Sahara

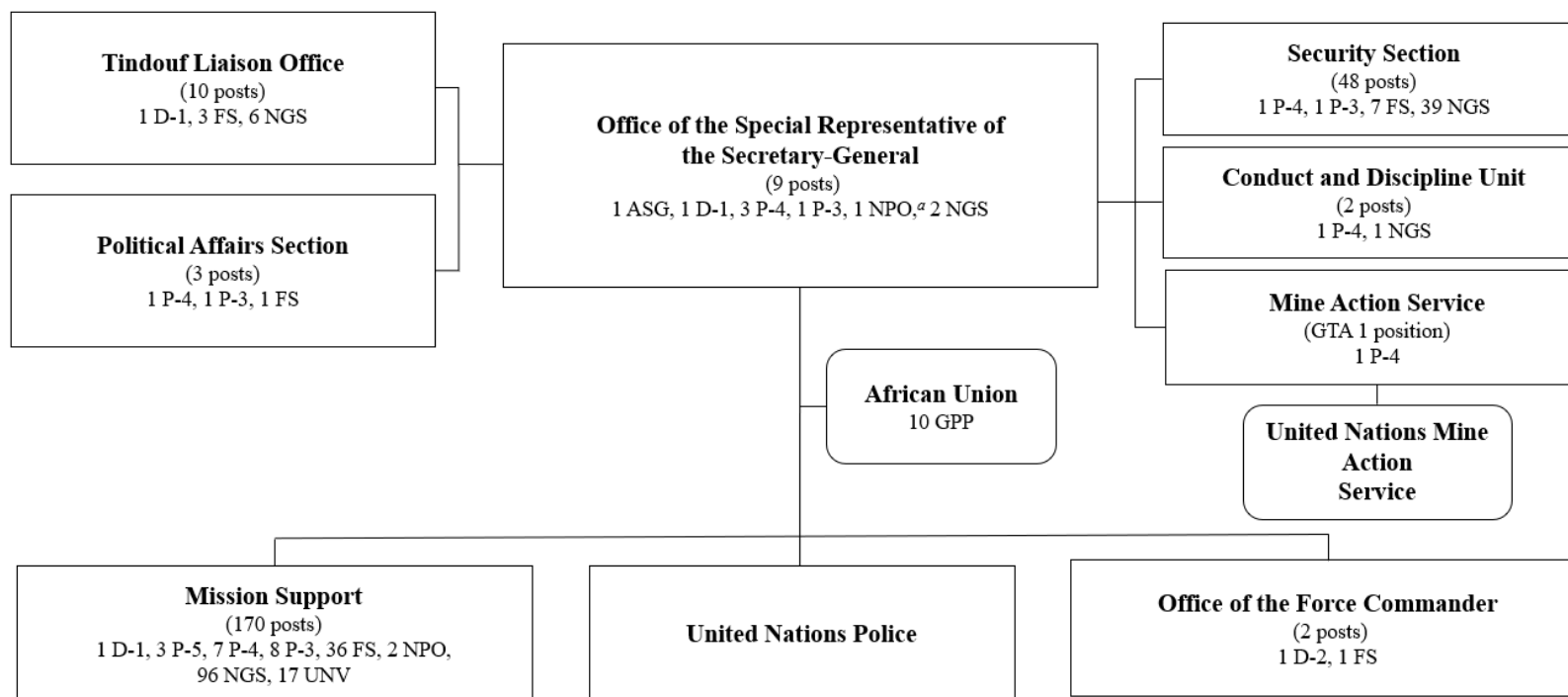
([A/79/724/Add.8](#) and General Assembly resolution [79/310](#))

<i>Request/recommendation</i>	<i>Action taken to implement request/recommendation</i>
The Advisory Committee recalls General Assembly resolution 76/274 and considers that, as a matter of principle, the Secretary-General should ensure the continuous optimization of the staffing structures, including through civilian and security staffing reviews, with the aim of identifying efficiencies that will be reflected in the next budget proposal (para. 15).	The Mission is preparing for the civilian staffing review in 2026.
The Advisory Committee trusts that information on the status of vacant posts, as well as on the impact of the liquidity situation on projected hirings, will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report and in the next budget submission. The Committee further trusts that all long-vacant posts will be critically reviewed in the context of the upcoming civilian staffing review (see para. 15 above) (para. 17).	The planned civilian staffing review, scheduled for 2026, will review all posts in the Mission and make recommendations on those posts that are essential for effective mandate implementation. Due to liquidity constraints, the Mission is currently subject to a recruitment freeze, which led to a higher number of vacant posts.
The Advisory Committee trusts that mine action requirements at MINURSO, as well as the mode of delivery of the related services, will be kept under review and that an update will be provided in the context of the next report of the Secretary-General (para. 31).	The change in delivery for the MINURSO mine action programme is not considered for 2026/27, as there has been no change in circumstances compared with 2025/26.

Annex

Organization charts

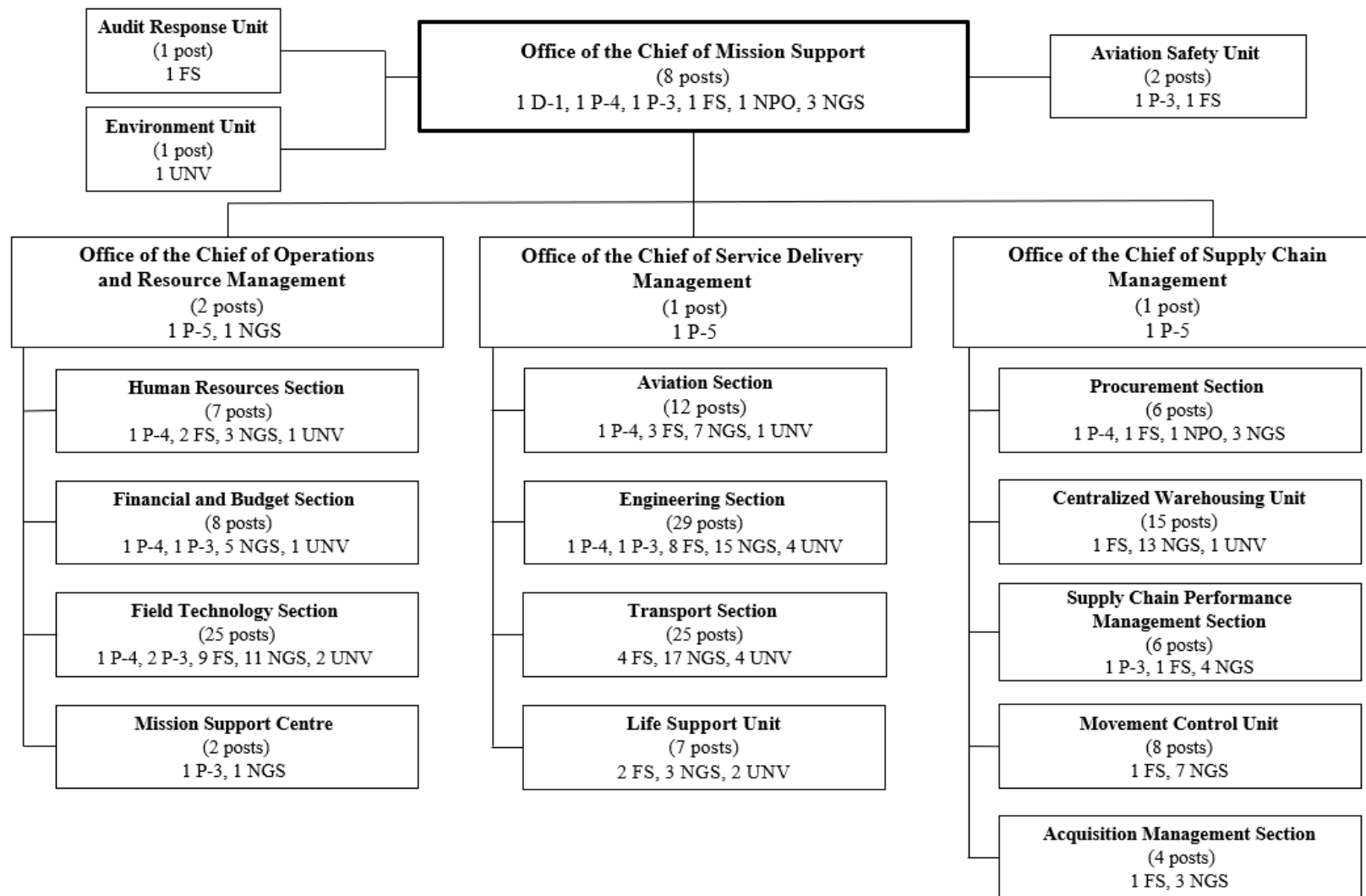
A. Substantive



Abbreviations: ASG, Assistant Secretary-General; FS, Field Service; GPP, government-provided personnel; GTA, general temporary assistance; NGS, national General Service; NPO, National Professional Officer; UNV, United Nations Volunteer.

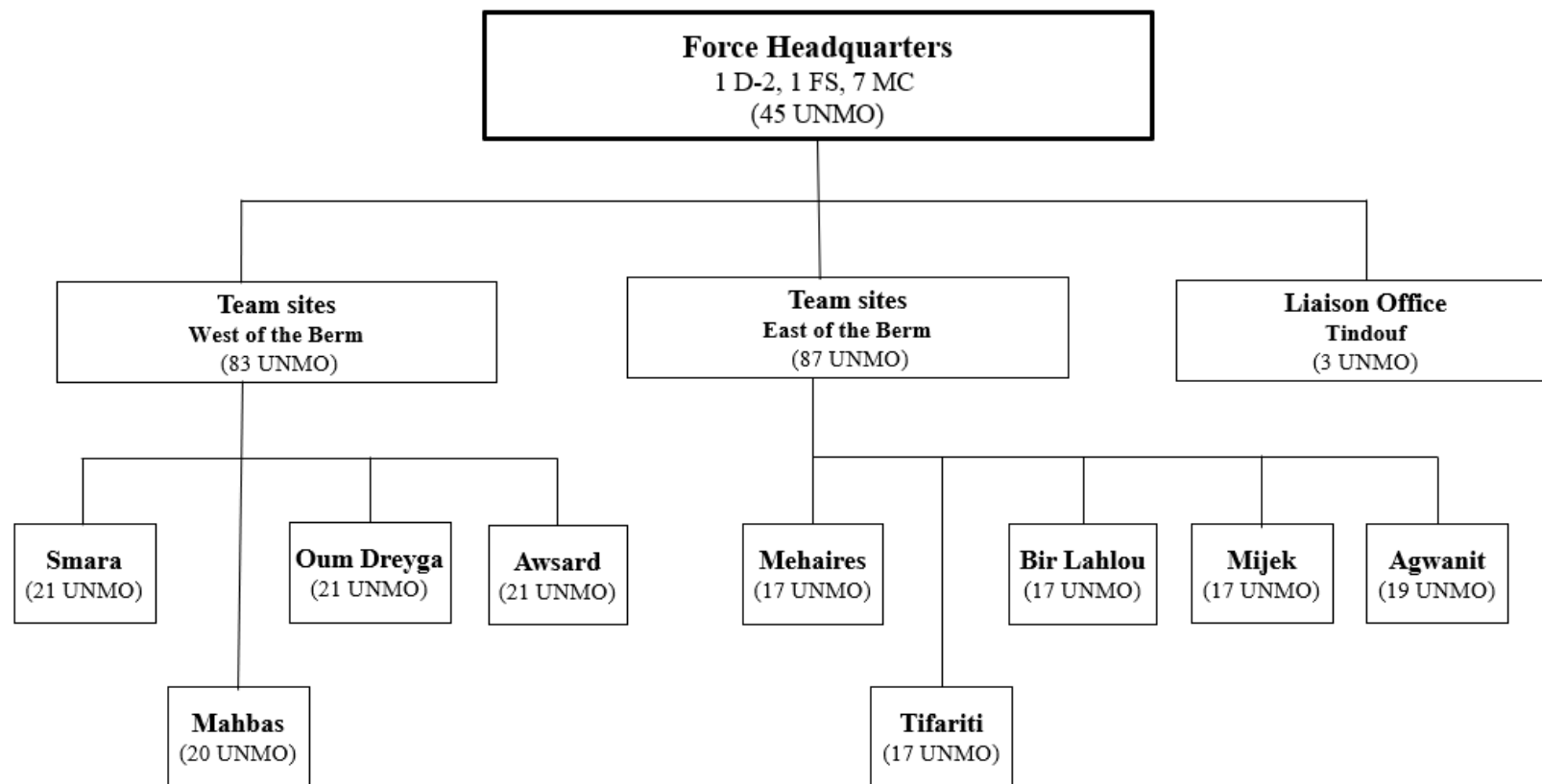
^a Conversion.

B. Support



Abbreviations: FS, Field Service; NGS, national General Service; NPO, National Professional Officer; UNV, United Nations Volunteer.

C. Military contingents and observers



Abbreviations: FS, Field Service; MC, military contingent; UNMO, United Nations military observers.

Map



Map No. 3691 Rev. 101 UNITED NATIONS
January 2026

Office of Information and Communications Technology
Geospatial Information Section